

without any distractions which allows you to focus entirely on the conversation.



Apple AirPods Max

Apple disrupted the headphones category with its AirPods Max – complete with an industrial look, deep Apple ecosystem integration, and Spatial Audio support with head tracking. The headphones house three micro-

phones for voice pick-up that do a good job of clearly relaying the speaker's voice while also reducing background chatter. While these aren't as reliable as the headphones we've mentioned above when it comes to calling clarity, these cans are still perfectly serviceable in an indoor environment that lacks a lot of ambient noise. So, if you're part of the Apple ecosystem already, these can be a good option for you for your daily work calls or online classes.



Jabra Elite 7 Pro

If you're looking for a TWS – instead of headphones – with a reliable microphone, none is better in our experience than the Jabra Elite 7 Pro. Despite the fact that these are more than a year old at the time of writing, they've still got the best micro-

phone setup we've experienced in TWS earphones. Four microphones work in tandem with a VPU (voice pick up) sensor to pick up the caller's voice clearly while cancelling out ambient sounds such as wind and traffic. There's barely any distortion in calls or voice recordings and the speaker's voice sounds full and natural.



Sony WF-1000XM4

Sony massively improved its microphone performance with the Sony WF-1000XM4 compared to its predecessor – the Mark 3s. Beamforming microphones coupled with bone conduction sensors result in excellent call quality where voices

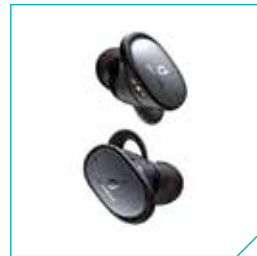
are extremely clear and void of distortion. Now, this set up doesn't work for everyone so, kudos to the Sony team for implementing bone conduction well and not just being a gimmicky feature. The microphone setup also drastically reduces ambient noise when on calls, meaning that even in noisy environments, you are going to be able to enjoy mostly distraction-free conversations.



Nothing Ear (2)

The Nothing Ear (2) has fantastic microphone intelligibility for its price. It has a six-microphone setup paired with Nothing's Clear Voice Technology that honestly, works wonders. This combined with the extended stems of the

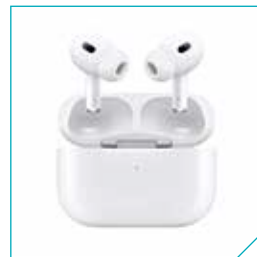
earbuds means that you'll get clear-sounding calls in which the caller's voice is crisp and natural-sounding. The background noise is mitigated to a degree which is rarely seen at its price point – be it traffic, fans, or your noisy coworkers. You will barely receive any complaints about call quality with the Nothing Ear (2) – which is a massive improvement over the Nothing Ear (1) which didn't provide as great results.



Soundcore Anker Liberty 2 Pro

While we haven't tested these earphones, the Soundcore Anker Liberty 2 Pro is known to have one of the best-performing microphone setups in TWS earphones. The Liberty 2 Pro sport quad-microphones

equipped with Qualcomm's cVc 8.0 noise reduction technology that allows for clear calls with minimal ambient noise. cVc is a suite of algorithms that enhance call quality by reducing echo, minimising packet loss, and enhancing the transmission of voice calls no matter where you are. The company claims 60 per cent less noise and precise voice isolation as well, so these look like fantastic TWS for calls, on paper.



AirPods Pro (2nd Generation)

The AirPods Pro (2nd Generation) made a lot of improvements over its predecessor. One of these is call quality. The AirPods Pro (2nd generation) come packing two beamforming microphones. The mics

face inwards, meaning they are located closer to your mouth which translates to better voice pick-up. In our testing, we found that the AirPods Pro (2nd Generation) has a dependable microphone. The microphone performs well even in large rooms and eliminates most of the echo. The caller's voice is usually clear and crisp in most conditions, making these ideal – especially for Apple users. **d**